

BEST OF INDIA

cover story

This festive season we present the Best of India, the ultimate guide to the finest experiences for the mind, body and soul, from food to adventure, the spiritual to the sublime, culture to travel. This is the magic that is India.



DESERT SONG

 **LIVE PERFORMANCE ■ JAISALMER, RAJASTHAN**

The best places to capture the romance of the desert are two little-known camps near Jaisalmer, Sam and Khuri which provide luxury tents for guests and lavish bar-be-cue dinners. The setting, with camels on the dunes, a campfire, and staff clad in local attire, is a return to ancient times when caravans passed through to trade in spices and gold. The pièce de résistance is the cultural show. Once the performance starts, the evening is truly magical with folk dancers, acrobats and singers piercing the silence of the desert. Local troupes of singers and dancers inspire the visitors to join in as well. Somehow, in the twilight, the performance is raised to a whole new level.

by Rohit Parihar